Leave Policy

Effective 1 January 2026. Applies to all regular employees. Leave is tracked in the People Portal and approved by the reporting manager.

1. Leave entitlements

Leave type	Entitlement per year	Carry forward	Notes
Casual leave (CL)	12 days	No - lapses on 31 December	Max 3 consecutive days; apply at least 1 day ahead
Sick leave (SL)	8 days	No	Medical certificate required for more than 2 consecutive days
Earned leave (EL)	15 days	Yes - up to 30 days	Encashable at exit; apply 7 days ahead
Maternity leave	26 weeks	n/a	As per the Maternity Benefit Act
Paternity leave	10 working days	No	Within 3 months of birth or adoption
Bereavement leave	5 days	No	Immediate family
Marriage leave	5 days	No	Once during employment

2. Casual leave

Employees get 12 casual leaves per calendar year, credited at 1 day per month. Casual leave cannot be carried forward to the next year and is not encashable. Casual leave may be taken as half days. Unplanned casual leave must be informed to the manager before 10:00 on the day of absence.

3. Sick leave

Employees get 8 sick leaves per year. A medical certificate is required for absences of more than 2 consecutive days. Unused sick leave lapses at year end.

4. Earned leave

Employees accrue 15 earned leaves per year (1.25 days per month). Up to 30 days can be carried forward. Earned leave beyond the carry-forward cap lapses. Earned leave balance is encashed at exit at basic salary rate.

5. Public holidays

Northwind observes 12 public holidays per year, published in the Holiday Calendar. Two additional optional (restricted) holidays may be chosen from the restricted list.

6. How to apply

- Open the People Portal > Leave > Apply.
- Choose the leave type and dates; half days are supported for CL and EL.
- Your manager approves within 2 working days; escalate to HR if no response.
- Leave without balance is treated as loss of pay unless approved by the department head.

7. Contacts

Questions about leave balances go to hr@northwind.example.